Comparing decimals lesson

My role Lesson author and editor

I built a model lesson that uses thermometers and number lines to make decimal comparison and rounding concrete.

ORIGINAL DOCUMENT EXCERPT

Lesson 4 Compare, Order, and Round Decimals

ESSENTIAL QUESTION How can a number line help compare and round decimals?

[Insert photo of a set of three digital lab thermometers shows readings of 4.198 °C, 4.891 °C, and 4.918 °C.] Look at the picture of three thermometers.

Write the three temperatures from least to greatest. _____, _____, _____

Explain in one sentence how you decided. _____

_____

Draw a horizontal number line that starts at 4 °C and ends at 5 °C.

Mark each tenth between 4 and 5 with a longer tick. Approximate where each point should be based on their tenths digit and plot them.

Finally, list the numbers in ascending order. The point farthest to the left has the least value and the one on the right has the greatest value. Guided Practice 1

A student streamed two science videos, one 4.5 minutes long and one 4.2 minutes long.
Which video is longer?

To answer this question, you can create a number line between 4 and 5.